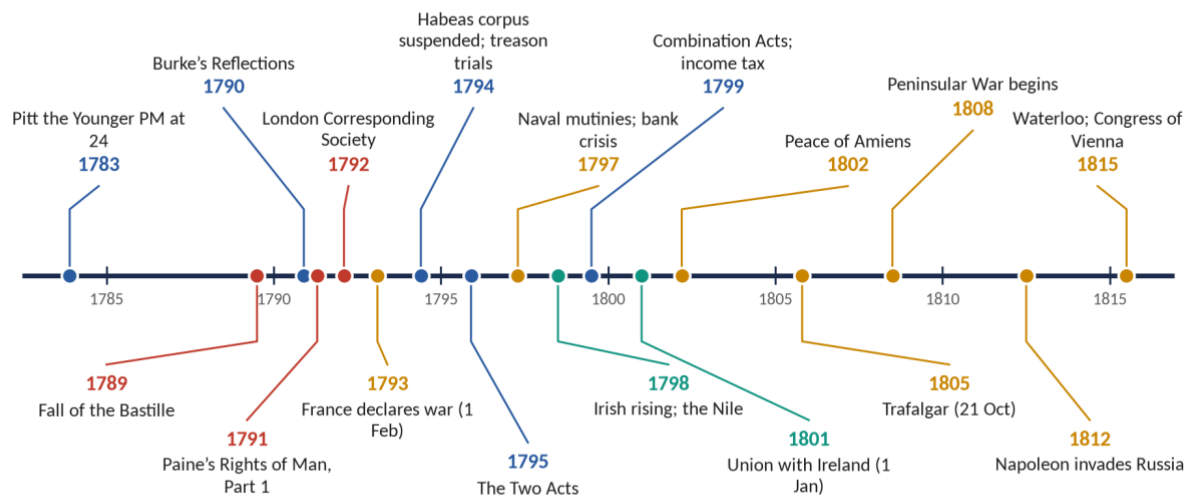


Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland (1783–1815)

Pitt the Younger, the French Revolution and its influence on Britain, Burke and Paine, repression, the wars against Napoleon, the Irish rising of 1798 and the Union of 1801

REVOLUTION, REACTION AND A WORLD WAR, 1783–1815

blue = government at home · red = radicals · gold = war · teal = Ireland



Syllabus heads IV and VI. Asked **6 times** in 2015–2026 — the Revolution's influence on Britain **five** times (2020 and 2022 **word for word**) — plus **3 MCQs**. Told as a story first, then five chapters, **100 one-liners** and a stand-alone **revision sheet**.

Topic 3 of 10 · read with the companion document T3QA

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HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents

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How to Use This Document

What this Topic covers

Topic 3 covers **1783** to **1815**: **Pitt the Younger**, the **French Revolution** and its influence on Britain, the great debate between **Burke** and **Paine**, the government's **repression** of radicals, the **Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars**, the Irish rising of **1798** and the **Act of Union** of **1801**. Syllabus **Head IV** (Union of England and Ireland) and **Head VI** (the French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars: causes, Britain and the wars, impact on Britain).

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why this topic matters

One family dominates: **the French Revolution's influence on Britain** — 2016, 2020, 2022, 2023 and a 2025 short note. **2020 Q3 and 2022 Q5 are identical**. The **Union of 1801** was set in 2025. Never set: **Britain and the Napoleonic Wars** — the fighting itself — although it is a named sub-head.

THE STORY IN SIMPLE WORDS · The story so far — where Topic 2 left us

In **1783** Britain had lost thirteen American colonies. Lord North had fallen; the King had defeated the Fox–North coalition; and in December 1783 George III made **William Pitt the Younger**, aged twenty-four, prime minister. The debt stood at about £240 million, Ireland had won its own Parliament (1782), and the old Whig world had broken up into factions.

The words this topic needs

Word	Meaning
Jacobin	A member of the radical club that dominated the French Revolution in 1793–94; in Britain, a term of abuse for any radical.
Radical	A reformer who wanted root-and-branch change — usually manhood suffrage and annual parliaments.
Corresponding society	A reform club that exchanged letters with others across the country; the London Corresponding Society (1792) was the most famous.
Loyalism	Organised support for King, Church and constitution — associations, songs, "Church and King" mobs.
Habeas corpus	The right not to be imprisoned without trial. Its "suspension" allowed detention without charge.
Sedition	Words or writings meant to stir up hatred of the government or constitution.
Combination	A trade union or workers' association; banned by the Combination Acts (1799–1800).
United Irishmen	The Irish society (1791) of Protestants and Catholics that sought reform, then independence with French help.

Word	Meaning
Coalition	An alliance of European powers against France — there were seven between 1793 and 1815.
Continental System	Napoleon's blockade of British trade with Europe (from 1806).
Orders in Council	Britain's counter-blockade of Napoleon's Europe (1807).
Concert of Europe	The system of great-power conferences created at Vienna (1815).

Part One — The Story

1.1 Pitt rebuilds the state (1783–1792)

William Pitt the Younger, son of Chatham, became prime minister in **December 1783** at twenty-four — "a kingdom trusted to a schoolboy's care", mocked his enemies. He won a large majority in the **1784** election and set about repairing the damage of the American war. He cut smuggling by lowering duties, created a new **sinking fund** (1786) to pay off debt, reorganised customs, and signed the **Eden Treaty** (1786), a free-trade agreement with France. The **India Act** (1784) put the East India Company under a Board of Control. His one attempt at parliamentary reform (1785) failed.

1.2 The Revolution and the great debate (1789–1792)

On **14 July 1789** a Paris crowd stormed the **Bastille**. Many Britons were delighted: **Charles James Fox** called it "how much the greatest event that ever happened in the world", and the young **Wordsworth** wrote, "Bliss was it in that dawn to be alive". The Dissenting minister **Richard Price** preached that Britain should follow France.

Edmund Burke replied with *Reflections on the Revolution in France* (**November 1790**): society was a partnership of the dead, the living and the unborn; rights came from inherited tradition; and the Revolution would end in bloodshed and tyranny. **Thomas Paine** answered with *Rights of Man* (**1791–92**): every generation had the right to govern itself, hereditary monarchy was absurd, and the poor should have pensions and schooling paid for by taxes on the rich. It sold perhaps **200,000** copies. **Mary Wollstonecraft** added *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792).

Reformers organised. The **London Corresponding Society**, founded in **January 1792** by the shoemaker **Thomas Hardy**, charged a penny a week and demanded **manhood suffrage** and **annual parliaments**. Loyalists organised too: in 1791 a "Church and King" mob in Birmingham burned the house and laboratory of the scientist and Dissenter **Joseph Priestley**.

1.3 From fear to repression (1792–1801)

In 1792 the Revolution turned violent — the **September Massacres**, the abolition of the monarchy — and on **21 January 1793** Louis XVI was guillotined. On **1 February 1793** France declared war on Britain. Fear of a British revolution became the governing fact of politics.

- A **Royal Proclamation** against seditious writings (May 1792); Paine was tried in his absence and outlawed.
- John **Reeves's** **loyalist associations** (November 1792) spread across the country.
- In Scotland, **Thomas Muir** and **Thomas Palmer** were sentenced to transportation (1793).

- **Habeas corpus** was suspended in **May 1794**; Hardy, **Horne Tooke** and **Thelwall** were tried for high treason — and **acquitted** by London juries.
- After a mob attacked the King's coach, the **Two Acts (1795)** widened the law of treason and banned meetings of more than fifty people without a magistrate's permission.
- The **Combination Acts (1799–1800)** outlawed trade unions; the **Unlawful Societies Act (1799)** banned the LCS.

The Whig party split in **1794** when the **Duke of Portland** and the conservative Whigs joined Pitt; **Fox** and a small group opposed the war and the repression. Reform was postponed for a generation.

THE FRENCH REVOLUTION IN BRITAIN: FROM ENTHUSIASM TO REPRESSION

Why reform was delayed forty years — and why it came in 1832

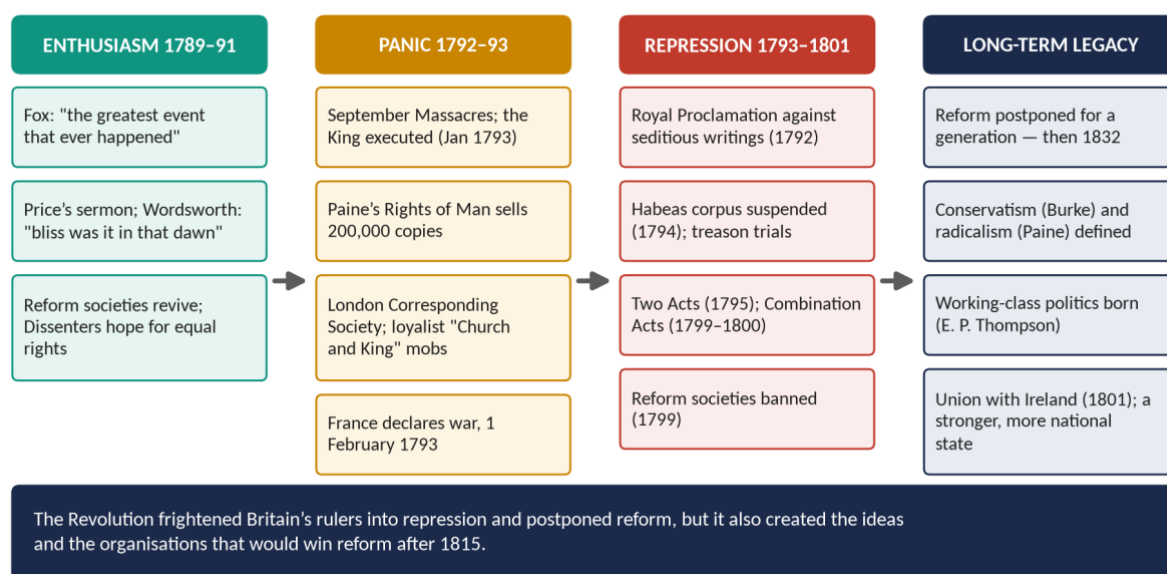


Figure 1 · *The French Revolution in Britain: from enthusiasm to panic, repression and long-term legacy.*

1.4 Ireland: rebellion and Union (1791–1801)

In Ireland the Revolution's ideas met old grievances. The **United Irishmen** (1791), led by the Protestant lawyer **Theobald Wolfe Tone**, united Catholics and Presbyterians in a demand first for reform and then for an independent republic. A French fleet reached **Bantry Bay** in December 1796 but storms prevented a landing. In **May–June 1798** risings broke out in Leinster, Antrim and Down; the rebels were crushed at **Vinegar Hill**. A small French force landed at **Killala** in August and surrendered at **Ballinamuck**. Perhaps **30,000** people died. Tone was captured and died in prison.

Pitt concluded that Ireland could only be secured by abolishing its Parliament. After one defeat (1799), the Irish Parliament voted itself out of existence in **1800**, persuaded by peerages, places and payments managed by **Castlereagh** and **Cornwallis**. The **Act of Union** took effect on **1 January 1801**: the **United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland**, with **100 Irish MPs** at Westminster. Pitt had hinted that **Catholic Emancipation** would follow; **George III** refused, and Pitt resigned (February 1801).

IRELAND: THE RISING OF 1798 AND THE UNION OF 1801

A rebellion with French help, crushed in weeks; Pitt's answer was to abolish the Irish Parliament

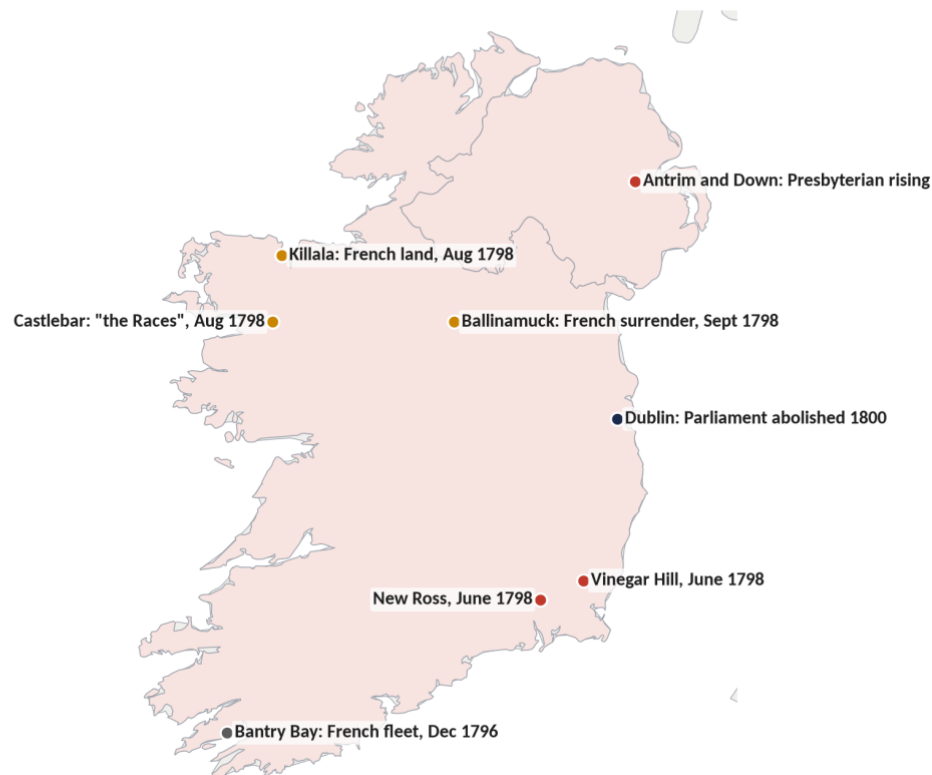


Figure 2 · The 1798 rising, the French landings, and the Dublin Parliament that the Union abolished.

1.5 The war against Napoleon (1793–1815)

Britain fought France almost continuously for twenty-two years. It was the richest power but had a small army, so its strategy was always the same: **command the sea, pay allies** on the continent, and strike where the navy could reach.

The navy did its part: **Glorious First of June** (1794), **Cape St Vincent** and **Camperdown** (1797), **Nelson's** destruction of the French fleet at the **Nile** (1798), and **Copenhagen** (1801). The **Peace of Amiens** (1802) lasted a year. From 1803 Napoleon massed an army at **Boulogne** to invade England; **Nelson's** victory at **Trafalgar** on **21 October 1805** ended that threat for ever, though Nelson died in the battle. Pitt, back in office from 1804, died in January 1806, exhausted.

On land Napoleon was unbeatable for a decade — Austerlitz (1805), Jena (1806), Friedland (1807). He tried to strangle Britain economically with the **Continental System** (1806), and Britain replied with the **Orders in Council** (1807). The breakthrough came in **Spain and Portugal**: from 1808 Sir Arthur Wellesley, later the **Duke of Wellington**, fought the **Peninsular War**, holding the lines of **Torres Vedras** (1810) and winning at **Salamanca** (1812) and **Vitoria** (1813). Napoleon's invasion of **Russia** (1812) destroyed his Grand Army; the allies beat him at **Leipzig** (1813) and he abdicated in April 1814. He escaped from Elba, and on **18 June 1815** **Wellington** and the Prussian **Blücher** defeated him at **Waterloo**.

At the **Congress of Vienna** (1814–15) **Castlereagh** helped build a **balance of power** to contain France. Britain took no European land but kept strategic bases: **Malta**, the **Cape Colony**, **Ceylon**, **Mauritius**, **Heligoland**, Trinidad and a protectorate over the **Ionian Islands**.

BRITAIN AGAINST NAPOLEON, 1793–1815

Sea power and coalitions: victories at sea kept Britain safe; the Peninsula and Waterloo finished the war

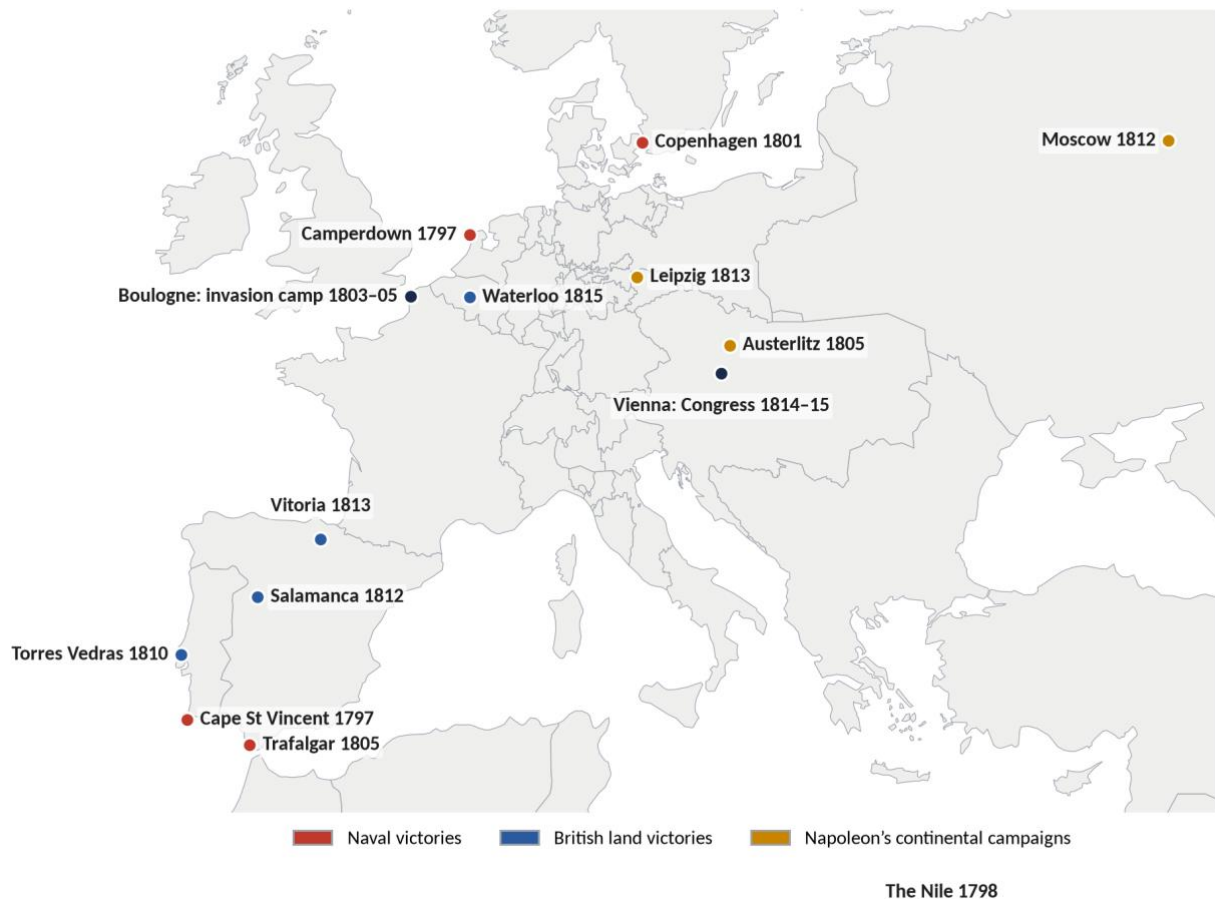


Figure 3 · Britain against Napoleon: the naval victories, the Peninsula and Waterloo.

1.6 The cost and the legacy

The war cost about **£1,000 million**. The **National Debt** rose from roughly £240 million to about **£745 million**. Pitt introduced **income tax** in **1799** (2s in the pound on incomes over £200). The navy and army employed half a million men. Victory made Britain the unchallenged world power of the nineteenth century — but it left a country of high taxes, unemployment and radical discontent, which exploded in the years after 1815 (Topic 5).

VERDICT · The story in one sentence

The French Revolution split British opinion, frightened its rulers into a generation of repression and postponed reform; the wars that followed drove Britain to abolish the Irish Parliament and to spend a thousand million pounds — and left it, in 1815, the greatest power in the world.

Part Two — The Cast and the Time-line

2.1 The cast

Person	Dates	Who they were — in one line
William Pitt the Younger	1759–1806; PM 1783–1801, 1804–06	Rebuilt the finances, led the war and repression, made the Union with Ireland.
Charles James Fox	1749–1806	Whig leader; welcomed the Revolution; opposed the war and the repression.
Edmund Burke	1729–97	Whig who wrote <i>Reflections</i> (1790) — the founding text of conservatism.
Thomas Paine	1737–1809	Author of <i>Rights of Man</i> (1791–92); outlawed in Britain.
Mary Wollstonecraft	1759–97	Wrote <i>A Vindication of the Rights of Woman</i> (1792).
Richard Price	1723–91	Dissenting minister whose sermon of 1789 provoked Burke.
Thomas Hardy	1752–1832	Shoemaker; founder of the London Corresponding Society; acquitted of treason in 1794.
Duke of Portland	1738–1809	Led the conservative Whigs into coalition with Pitt (1794).
Theobald Wolfe Tone	1763–98	Founder of the United Irishmen; sought French help.
Lord Castlereagh	1769–1822	Carried the Irish Union; Foreign Secretary at Vienna.
Horatio Nelson	1758–1805	Victor of the Nile, Copenhagen and Trafalgar; killed at Trafalgar.
Duke of Wellington	1769–1852	Won the Peninsular War and Waterloo.
Napoleon Bonaparte	1769–1821	Emperor of the French 1804–14, 1815.

2.2 The time-line

REVOLUTION, REACTION AND A WORLD WAR, 1783–1815

blue = government at home · red = radicals · gold = war · teal = Ireland

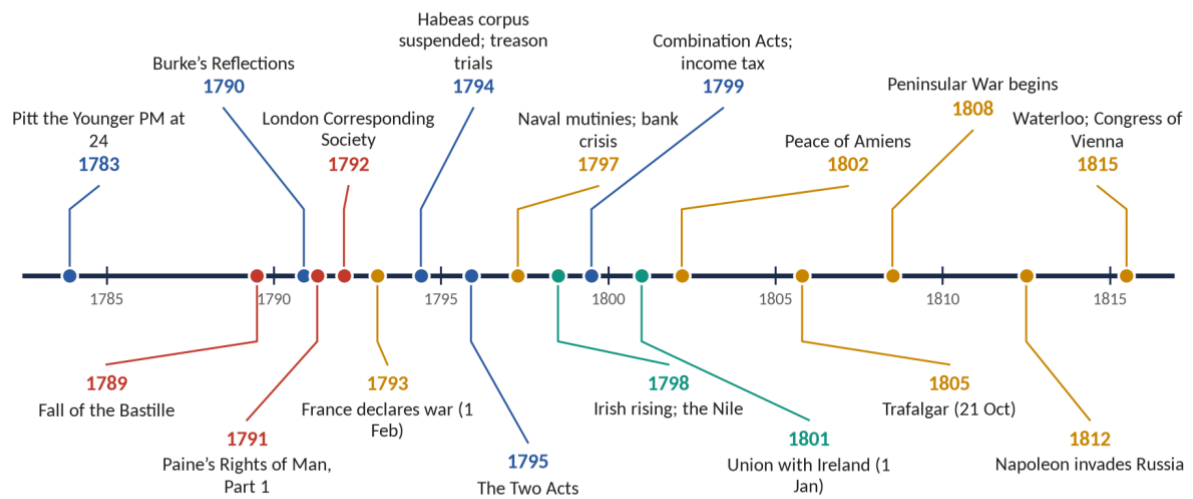


Figure 4 · Revolution, reaction and a world war, 1783–1815.

Part Three — The Chapters

Chapter 1 · Pitt the Younger, 1783–1801

1.1 How he came to power

- **December 1783:** George III dismissed the Fox–North coalition over Fox's India Bill and appointed Pitt, aged 24.
- **1784 election:** Pitt won a large majority with royal patronage and genuine public support.

1.2 The peacetime reformer (1784–92)

Policy	What it did
Finance	New sinking fund (1786); consolidated customs duties; lower duties to defeat smuggling (tea duty cut from 119% to 12.5%)
Trade	Eden Treaty (1786) with France — freer trade, influenced by Adam Smith
India	India Act (1784): a government Board of Control over the East India Company
Canada	Constitutional Act (1791): Upper and Lower Canada with elected assemblies
Reform	Proposed to abolish 36 rotten boroughs (1785) — defeated; he did not try again
Slave trade	Supported Wilberforce's motions personally, but never made abolition government policy

1.3 The war minister and the repressor (1793–1801)

Pitt was a better peace minister than war minister: his early strategy of colonial expeditions and continental subsidies failed to stop French expansion. At home he became the author of "**Pitt's Terror**" — the repressive laws of 1792–1801 (Chapter 2). He introduced **income tax** (1799), carried the **Union with Ireland** (1800), and resigned in **1801** when the King refused Catholic Emancipation. He returned in 1804 and died in January **1806**.

VERDICT · Pitt in one line

A brilliant financial reformer before 1793, a determined but not brilliant war leader after it, and the man who tied Ireland to Britain — his reputation as the founder of modern Toryism was made by others after his death.

Chapter 2 · The French Revolution and Britain

2.1 The causes of the Revolution (in brief)

1. **Bankruptcy:** France's debt, swollen by the American war, forced Louis XVI to call the **Estates-General** (May 1789).
2. **Privilege:** nobles and clergy were largely exempt from taxes; the Third Estate bore the burden.
3. **Enlightenment ideas:** Rousseau's popular sovereignty; the example of America.
4. **Hunger:** the harvest of 1788 failed and bread prices peaked in July 1789.

2.2 British reactions — three phases

Phase	What happened
Welcome, 1789–91	Fox, Price, the Dissenters and the young Romantics saw France following Britain's 1688; reform societies revived
Division and fear, 1791–93	Burke v Paine; the LCS; the Priestley riots; the September Massacres; the King's execution; war (1 Feb 1793)
Repression and war, 1793–1801	Proclamation, loyalist associations, treason trials, habeas corpus suspended, Two Acts, Combination Acts, LCS banned

2.3 The influence on political thought

THE GREAT ARGUMENT: BURKE AGAINST PAINE

The debate that created modern British conservatism and radicalism

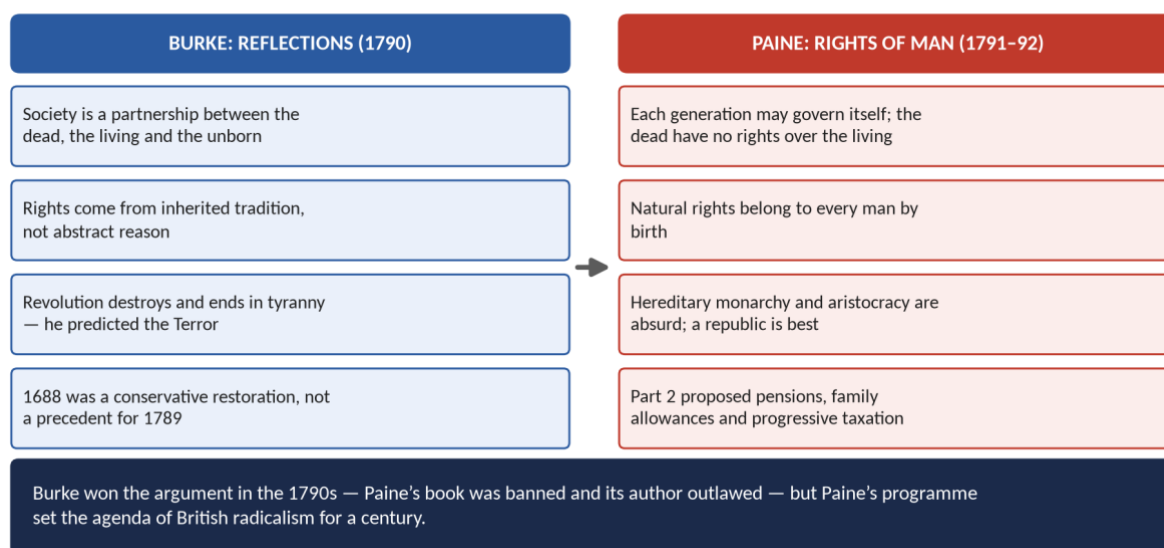


Figure 5 · Burke against Paine: the argument that shaped British conservatism and radicalism.

- **Burke** founded modern **conservatism**: society as an organic inheritance; change by gradual reform, not revolution.
- **Paine** gave British **radicalism** its programme: natural rights, manhood suffrage, a republic, welfare paid by progressive taxes.
- **Wollstonecraft** (1792) extended rights to **women**; **William Godwin's** *Political Justice* (1793) pushed reason towards anarchism.
- **Party**: the **Whigs split** (1794); the Tories became the party of order; the word "Jacobin" discredited reform for thirty years.
- **Long run**: the language of rights re-emerged in the reform agitation after 1815 and in Chartism (Topic 4).

2.4 The influence on society

- **Popular politics**: artisans organised for the first time in national societies — for **E. P. Thompson** the moment the English working class began to "make itself".
- **Loyalism**: far larger than radicalism — hundreds of associations, "Church and King" crowds, volunteer corps of over 400,000 men by 1804.
- **Religion**: the evangelical revival grew; the ruling class embraced religion as a barrier to revolution.
- **Culture**: Wordsworth, Coleridge and Southey moved from enthusiasm to conservatism.
- **War economy**: income tax, high prices, food riots (1795, 1800), the naval mutinies at **Spithead** and the **Nore** (1797), and the Bank of England's suspension of cash payments (1797).
- **National identity**: **Linda Colley** argues that the long war with France forged a stronger sense of being **British**.

2.5 The government's measures — a list to learn

Year	Measure	Aim
1792	Royal Proclamation against seditious writings	Stop the circulation of Paine
1792	Reeves's loyalist associations	Mobilise loyal opinion; report radicals
1793	Scottish sedition trials (Muir, Palmer)	Exemplary punishment
1793	Aliens Act	Watch French émigrés and agents
1794	Habeas corpus suspended	Detain radicals without trial
1794	Treason trials of Hardy, Horne Tooke, Thelwall	Destroy the LCS leadership (failed: acquitted)
1795	Two Acts : Treasonable Practices; Seditious Meetings	Widen treason; ban large meetings
1797	Newspaper Act; mutineers executed	Control the press and the forces
1799	Unlawful Societies Act	Ban the LCS and United Irishmen
1799–1800	Combination Acts	Ban trade unions
1800–01	Act of Union	Close the Irish "back door"

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 2 has been asked

2016 Q2 (measures to check the influence) · **2020 Q3** = **2022 Q5** (influence on English society and political thought) · **2023 Q3** (the "panic" and the after-effects) · **2025 Q8(a)** short note (impact on economy and society). All answered in T3QA.

Chapter 3 · Britain and the Napoleonic Wars

3.1 Why Britain fought

- **Security:** French occupation of the Low Countries — the coast opposite England — and the opening of the Scheldt (1792).
- **The balance of power:** France under the Republic and then Napoleon dominated Europe.
- **Trade and empire:** French policy threatened British commerce and colonies.
- **Ideology:** after 1793, a war against revolution.

3.2 Britain's strategy

1. **Sea power:** blockade, protect trade, seize enemy colonies.
2. **Subsidies:** gold to Austria, Prussia and Russia — seven coalitions.
3. **Peripheral land war:** small expeditions, then the **Peninsula**.
4. **Economic war:** the **Orders in Council** against the **Continental System**.

3.3 The key actions

Year	Action	Significance
1794	Glorious First of June	First great naval victory of the war
1797	Cape St Vincent; Camperdown	Spanish and Dutch fleets defeated
1798	The Nile	Nelson destroys the French fleet; Napoleon stranded in Egypt
1801	Copenhagen	Danish fleet neutralised
1802	Peace of Amiens	A one-year truce
1805	Trafalgar (21 Oct)	Franco-Spanish fleet destroyed; invasion impossible; Nelson killed
1806–07	Continental System; Orders in Council	Economic war
1808–14	Peninsular War	Torres Vedras (1810), Salamanca (1812), Vitoria (1813) — the "Spanish ulcer"
1812	Invasion of Russia	Napoleon's Grand Army destroyed
1813	Leipzig	The Battle of the Nations
1815	Waterloo (18 June)	Wellington and Blücher end the Hundred Days

3.4 Why Britain won

1. **Naval supremacy** — Trafalgar made Britain invulnerable.

2. **Money** — the income tax, the Bank and the National Debt paid for its own forces and its allies'.
3. **Industry** — the Industrial Revolution supplied arms and exports.
4. **Allies** — Russia, Austria and Prussia provided the armies.
5. **Wellington** — and the Spanish resistance.
6. **Napoleon's mistakes** — Spain and Russia.

3.5 The Congress of Vienna (1814–15)

- **Castlereagh's** aims: contain France, restore a **balance of power**, and keep Britain free of continental commitments.
- **Results**: a strengthened **Netherlands** (with Belgium) and **Prussia** on the Rhine; **Austria** dominant in Italy; the **Bourbons** restored in France; the **Concert of Europe**.
- **Britain's gains**: **Malta**, the **Cape Colony**, **Ceylon**, **Mauritius**, **Heligoland**, **Trinidad**, **Tobago**, **St Lucia**, and the **Ionian Islands**.

3.6 The impact of the wars on Britain

Area	Impact
Finance	War cost about £1,000 million; debt rose to about £745 million; income tax 1799–1816
Economy	Industrial growth (iron, cotton); high food prices; the Corn Law of 1815 to protect farmers
Society	Unemployment after demobilisation of some 300,000 men; Luddism (1811–16)
Politics	Tory dominance (1807–30); repression continued — Spa Fields (1816), Peterloo and the Six Acts (1819)
World role	The only global power; naval supremacy for a century; the "Pax Britannica"

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · The blind spot

"**Britain and the Napoleonic Wars**" is a named sub-head that has **never** been set as a full question. Be ready to answer "*How did Britain defeat Napoleon?*" or "*Assess the impact of the Napoleonic Wars on Britain.*"

Chapter 4 · The Union with Ireland, 1801

4.1 Ireland before the Union

- A **Protestant Ascendancy** ruled a Catholic majority (about three-quarters of the population) through the **Penal Laws**.
- **Grattan's Parliament** (1782): the Irish Parliament won legislative independence during the American war — but it remained Protestant and managed from Dublin Castle.
- Catholic Relief Acts of **1792–93** gave Catholics the vote, but not seats in Parliament.
- The **United Irishmen** (1791) under **Wolfe Tone**, inspired by France, sought first reform and then a republic.

4.2 The rising of 1798

- A French fleet reached **Bantry Bay** (1796) but could not land.
- **Martial law** and brutal disarming in Ulster (1797).
- **Rising**: Leinster, **Wexford** (Vinegar Hill, 21 June), Antrim and Down; sectarian killing on both sides.
- **The French**: General Humbert landed at **Killala** (August), won at Castlebar, surrendered at **Ballinamuck**.
- **Toll**: perhaps **30,000** dead.

4.3 Pitt's reasons for Union

1. **Security**: close the "back door" to France in wartime.
2. **Control**: Grattan's Parliament had shown it could disagree with London (for example on the Regency Crisis of 1788–89).
3. **Religion**: inside a Protestant United Kingdom, Catholics could be emancipated without endangering Protestant rule.
4. **Economics**: free trade with Britain would bring Ireland prosperity.

4.4 The terms

- The **United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland** from **1 January 1801**.
- **100 Irish MPs** at Westminster; **28 Irish peers** and **4 bishops** in the Lords.
- The Churches of England and Ireland united as one Protestant established church.
- Free trade (with some temporary duties); separate Irish exchequer until 1817.

4.5 The controversies

- **Corruption:** after the Irish Commons rejected Union in 1799, Castlereagh and Cornwallis won it in 1800 with peerages, places and compensation of about £1.25 million to the owners of abolished boroughs.
- **Protestant opposition: Grattan** and the Orange lodges resisted the loss of "their" Parliament.
- **Catholic hope and betrayal:** many Catholic bishops supported Union on the understanding that Emancipation would follow; **George III** refused (his coronation oath), and Pitt resigned (1801). Emancipation came only in **1829** — extracted by O'Connell.

4.6 The consequences

- **Irish nationalism** changed character: from a Protestant patriot movement to a **Catholic** national movement — **Emmet** (1803), **O'Connell's** Repeal campaign (1840s), Young Ireland (1848), the **Fenians** (1858), **Home Rule** (1870s–1914), independence (1922).
- **The Famine** (1845–49) under the Union poisoned relations for ever.
- **Instability for the UK:** the **Irish Question** broke Peel's party (1846) and Gladstone's (1886); Irish MPs decided who governed in 1885–86 and 1910.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Where Chapter 4 has been asked

2025 Q3: *"Analyze the controversies surrounding the Act of Union 1801..."* — answered in T3QA. MCQ **2026:** the Act created the United Kingdom of **Great Britain and Ireland**.

Part Four — Historians and Quotations

Historian or source	The view to quote
Edmund Burke , <i>Reflections</i> (1790)	Society is "a partnership... between those who are living, those who are dead, and those who are to be born".
Thomas Paine , <i>Rights of Man</i> (1791)	"The vanity and presumption of governing beyond the grave is the most ridiculous and insolent of all tyrannies."
E. P. Thompson , <i>The Making of the English Working Class</i> (1963)	The 1790s were when the working class began to "make itself" — and "Pitt's Terror" drove it underground.
Linda Colley , <i>Britons</i> (1992)	The war with France forged a patriotic British identity across classes.
H. T. Dickinson	Loyalism was a mass movement, far larger than radicalism.
Eric Hobsbawm , <i>The Age of Revolution</i> (1962)	The "dual revolution" — French political and British industrial — made the modern world.

"How much the greatest event it is that ever happened in the world, and how much the best!" — **Charles James Fox**, on the fall of the Bastille, 1789

"Bliss was it in that dawn to be alive, / But to be young was very heaven!" — **William Wordsworth**, *The Prelude*

"England expects that every man will do his duty." — **Nelson's** signal at Trafalgar, 1805

"It has been a damned nice thing — the nearest run thing you ever saw in your life." — **Wellington**, on Waterloo

Part Five — The Examiner's Record

Paper	The question as set	Family	Type
2016 · Q2 · Section A	What measures were adopted by England to check the influence of the French Revolution of 1789 on England?	The French Revolution and Britain	Policy analysis
2020 · Q3 · Section A	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	The French Revolution and Britain	Impact / significance
2022 · Q5 · Section A	Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.	The French Revolution and Britain	Impact / significance
2023 · Q3 · Section A	'The English people got so much frightened by the developments in France that there prevailed a sort of panic across the country.' Analyse the after-effects of the French Revolution on England.	The French Revolution and Britain	Quotation / claim
2025 · Q3 · Section A	Analyze the controversies surrounding the Act of Union 1801, focusing on the differing perspectives of Irish and British politicians. Assess its impact on Irish nationalism and the stability of the United Kingdom.	Union with Ireland, 1801	How far / extent
2025 · Q8(a) · Section B	<i>Short note:</i> Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society	The French Revolution and Britain	Short note

Part Six — The One-Liner Bank

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use the one-liners

Cover the answer after the arrow. **100 questions**; bold words are the ones examiners test. The past MCQs are solved in T3QA.

One-liners · Pitt the Younger

1. When did **Pitt the Younger** become prime minister, and at what age? → **December 1783**, aged **24**.
2. Whose son was Pitt the Younger? → **Pitt the Elder, Earl of Chatham**.
3. Which coalition did George III dismiss to make Pitt PM? → The **Fox–North coalition**.
4. Which Act of **1784** set up a Board of Control over the East India Company? → The **India Act**.
5. Which fund did Pitt create in **1786** to pay off debt? → A new **sinking fund**.
6. Which **1786** trade treaty did Pitt sign with France? → The **Eden Treaty**.
7. By how much did Pitt cut the duty on tea? → From **119%** to **12.5%**.
8. What happened to Pitt's reform bill of **1785**? → It was **defeated**; he never tried again.
9. Which Act of **1791** created Upper and Lower Canada? → The **Constitutional Act**.
10. When did Pitt introduce **income tax**? → **1799**.
11. Why did Pitt resign in **1801**? → George III refused **Catholic Emancipation**.
12. When did Pitt die? → **January 1806**.

One-liners · The Revolution and the debate

13. When did the Paris crowd storm the **Bastille**? → **14 July 1789**.
14. Who called the Revolution "how much the greatest event... that ever happened in the world"? → **Charles James Fox**.
15. Which poet wrote "Bliss was it in that dawn to be alive"? → **William Wordsworth**.
16. Whose **1789** sermon provoked Burke? → **Richard Price's**.
17. When was Burke's *Reflections on the Revolution in France* published? → **November 1790**.
18. What did Burke call society? → A **partnership** between the **dead, the living and the unborn**.
19. Who wrote *Rights of Man* (**1791–92**)? → **Thomas Paine**.
20. Roughly how many copies of *Rights of Man* were sold? → About **200,000**.

21. What did Part 2 of *Rights of Man* propose? → **Pensions, family allowances and schooling** funded by progressive taxes.
22. Who wrote *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792)? → **Mary Wollstonecraft**.
23. Who wrote *Political Justice* (1793)? → **William Godwin**.
24. Which scientist's house was burned by a "Church and King" mob in 1791? → **Joseph Priestley's** (Birmingham).
25. When and by whom was the **London Corresponding Society** founded? → **January 1792**, by the shoemaker **Thomas Hardy**.
26. What were the LCS's two main demands? → **Manhood suffrage** and **annual parliaments**.
27. What was the LCS subscription? → **A penny a week**.
28. Which aristocratic Whig reform club was founded in 1792? → The **Friends of the People** (Charles Grey).
29. When was **Louis XVI** executed? → **21 January 1793**.
30. When did France declare war on Britain? → **1 February 1793**.
31. What did the 2026 MCQ ask about the Revolution and war? → "The French Revolution led to Britain..." — answer **None of these: France declared war on Britain**.
32. Which historian said the working class "made itself" in these years? → **E. P. Thompson**.
33. Which historian stressed loyalism as a mass movement? → **H. T. Dickinson**.

One-liners · Repression

34. What did the **Royal Proclamation** of May 1792 target? → **Seditious writings** — above all Paine.
35. What happened to Paine in Britain? → He was **tried in his absence and outlawed** (1792).
36. Who founded the **loyalist associations** (November 1792)? → **John Reeves**.
37. Which Scottish reformers were transported in 1793? → **Thomas Muir** and **Thomas Palmer**.
38. When was **habeas corpus** suspended? → **May 1794**.
39. Who were tried for high treason in 1794? → **Thomas Hardy, John Horne Tooke** and **John Thelwall**.
40. What was the verdict? → **Acquitted** by London juries.
41. What were the **Two Acts** of 1795? → The **Treasonable Practices Act** and the **Seditious Meetings Act**.
42. What event provoked the Two Acts? → An attack on the **King's coach** (October 1795).
43. What did the Seditious Meetings Act ban? → Meetings of more than **50** people without a magistrate's permission.
44. Which Acts of **1799–1800** banned trade unions? → The **Combination Acts**.

- 45. When were the Combination Acts repealed? → **1824**.
- 46. Which Act of **1799** banned the LCS? → The **Unlawful Societies Act**.
- 47. When did the Whig party split over the Revolution? → **1794** — **Portland** joined Pitt.
- 48. Who led the Foxite Whigs in opposition? → **Charles James Fox**.
- 49. What did Whigs call the repression? → "**Pitt's Terror**".
- 50. Where did the naval mutinies of **1797** take place? → **Spithead** and the **Nore**.
- 51. What did the Bank of England suspend in **1797**? → **Cash payments** (paying notes in gold).

One-liners · Ireland and the Union

- 52. What was "**Grattan's Parliament**"? → The Irish Parliament after it won **legislative independence in 1782**.
- 53. When were the **United Irishmen** founded, and by whom? → **1791**, by **Theobald Wolfe Tone**.
- 54. Where did a French fleet fail to land in December **1796**? → **Bantry Bay**.
- 55. When was the great Irish rising? → **May–June 1798**.
- 56. Where were the Wexford rebels defeated? → **Vinegar Hill** (21 June 1798).
- 57. Where did the French land in August **1798**? → **Killala** (County Mayo).
- 58. Where did the French surrender? → **Ballinamuck**.
- 59. Roughly how many died in 1798? → About **30,000**.
- 60. Which two men carried the Union through the Irish Parliament? → **Castlereagh** and **Cornwallis**.
- 61. When did the **Act of Union** take effect? → **1 January 1801**.
- 62. What did the Act of Union 1801 create? → The **United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland**.
- 63. How many Irish MPs sat at Westminster? → **100**.
- 64. How many Irish peers and bishops sat in the Lords? → **28 peers** and **4 bishops**.
- 65. What was united along with the Parliaments? → The **Churches of England and Ireland**.
- 66. When was **Catholic Emancipation** finally granted? → **1829**.
- 67. Who led the Irish rising of **1803**? → **Robert Emmet**.

One-liners · The wars against France and Napoleon

- 68. What was Britain's basic war strategy? → **Sea power, subsidies** to allies, and peripheral **expeditions**.
- 69. Which naval victory came in **1794**? → The **Glorious First of June**.

70. Which two naval victories came in **1797**? → **Cape St Vincent** and **Camperdown**.
71. Where did Nelson destroy the French fleet in **1798**? → **The Nile** (Aboukir Bay).
72. Which **1801** battle neutralised the Danish fleet? → **Copenhagen**.
73. Which treaty brought a brief peace in **1802**? → The **Peace of Amiens**.
74. Where did Napoleon mass his invasion army in **1803–05**? → **Boulogne**.
75. When was the Battle of **Trafalgar**? → **21 October 1805**.
76. What was Nelson's signal at Trafalgar? → "**England expects that every man will do his duty**."
77. What was Napoleon's economic blockade of Britain called? → The **Continental System** (1806).
78. What was Britain's counter-blockade? → The **Orders in Council** (1807).
79. When was the **Peninsular War**? → **1808–1814**.
80. Which defensive lines protected Lisbon in **1810**? → The Lines of **Torres Vedras**.
81. Which two Peninsular victories came in **1812** and **1813**? → **Salamanca** and **Vitoria**.
82. When did Napoleon invade **Russia**? → **1812**.
83. Which **1813** battle was called the Battle of the Nations? → **Leipzig**.
84. When was the Battle of **Waterloo**? → **18 June 1815**.
85. Who commanded the allies at Waterloo? → **Wellington** and the Prussian **Blücher**.
86. What did Wellington call Waterloo? → "**The nearest run thing you ever saw**."
87. Who represented Britain at the **Congress of Vienna**? → **Castlereagh** (and Wellington).
88. What system of great-power meetings did Vienna create? → The **Concert of Europe**.
89. Name four British gains in 1815. → **Malta, the Cape Colony, Ceylon, Mauritius** (also Heligoland, Trinidad, the Ionian Islands).
90. Roughly how much did the wars cost Britain? → About **£1,000 million**.
91. What was the National Debt by 1815? → About **£745 million**.

One-liners · The impact on Britain

92. Which protectionist law of **1815** kept out foreign grain? → The **Corn Law**.
93. Which machine-breaking movement peaked in **1811–16**? → **Luddism**.
94. Which **1816** London meetings led to riot? → The **Spa Fields** meetings.
95. Which **1819** Manchester meeting was broken up by cavalry? → **Peterloo** (St Peter's Field).
96. Which laws of **1819** followed Peterloo? → The **Six Acts**.
97. Which historian argued that the war forged a British identity? → **Linda Colley**.
98. Which party dominated government from 1807 to 1830? → The **Tories**.
99. When was income tax abolished after the war? → **1816**.

100. Which historian coined the "dual revolution"? → **Eric Hobsbawm.**

Part Seven — Revision Sheet · Topic 3: Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland, 1783–1815

HOW TO USE THIS · How to use this sheet

Complete on its own for the night before the paper. Syllabus **Head IV** (Union of England and Ireland) and **Head VI** (French Revolution and Napoleonic Wars). Asked **2016, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2025 (twice)**.

R3.1 The story in eight lines

1. **1783: Pitt the Younger** PM at 24; restores finances (sinking fund 1786, lower duties, Eden Treaty), India Act 1784.
2. **1789**: the **Bastille** falls; Fox and Price welcome it; **Burke's** *Reflections* (1790) attacks it; **Paine's** *Rights of Man* (1791–92) defends it.
3. **1792**: the **London Corresponding Society** (Hardy) demands manhood suffrage; loyalists and "Church and King" mobs answer.
4. **1793**: Louis XVI executed; France declares war (**1 February**).
5. **1792–1801**: repression — Proclamation, habeas corpus suspended (1794), treason trials, **Two Acts** (1795), **Combination Acts** (1799–1800).
6. **1798**: Irish rising (Wolfe Tone; Vinegar Hill; French at Killala) → **Act of Union**, in force **1 January 1801**; Pitt resigns over Catholic Emancipation.
7. **1793–1815**: war — the **Nile** (1798), **Trafalgar** (1805), the **Peninsula** (1808–14), Russia (1812), Leipzig (1813), **Waterloo** (18 June 1815).
8. **1815: Congress of Vienna**; Britain the world power, with Malta, the Cape and Ceylon; debt £745 million; the Corn Law and post-war unrest follow.

R3.2 The influence of the Revolution on political thought

- **Burke**: tradition, prescription, gradual change → **modern conservatism**.
- **Paine**: natural rights, a republic, welfare from progressive tax → **modern radicalism**.
- **Wollstonecraft** (1792): women's rights; **Godwin** (1793): reason and anarchism.
- **Party**: Whigs split (**1794**); Tories become the party of order; "Jacobin" discredits reform until **1832**.

R3.3 The influence on society

- **Popular politics:** the LCS and the corresponding societies — working men organise (**E. P. Thompson**).
- **Loyalism:** the larger movement — associations, volunteers (400,000 by 1804), "Church and King" riots (**Dickinson**).
- **War society:** income tax (1799), food riots, mutinies (1797), bank crisis (1797), a stronger **British** identity (**Colley**).
- **Religion and culture:** evangelical revival; the Romantic poets turn from enthusiasm to conservatism.

R3.4 The measures to check the Revolution

Propaganda (Proclamation 1792; Reeves's associations; Paine outlawed) · **Trials** (Muir and Palmer 1793; Hardy, Horne Tooke, Thelwall 1794 — acquitted) · **Laws** (habeas corpus suspended 1794; **Two Acts** 1795; **Combination Acts** 1799–1800; Unlawful Societies Act 1799) · **Force** (militia, volunteers, barracks, spies) · **Ireland** (martial law 1798; Union 1801). **Verdict:** no revolution — but liberty curtailed and reform postponed a generation.

R3.5 "Panic" and the after-effects

The panic was that of the **propertied classes** (September Massacres, the regicide, invasion scares); most people were loyal. **After-effects:** Whig split and Tory dominance; repression; unions outlawed until 1824; the Union with Ireland; twenty-two years of war and debt; conservatism and radicalism defined; reform delayed to 1832 but its language created.

R3.6 The Union of 1801

- **Background:** Protestant Ascendancy; Grattan's Parliament (1782); United Irishmen (1791); rising of **1798** (~30,000 dead).
- **Pitt's reasons:** security in war; control of the Irish Parliament; Emancipation inside a Protestant UK; free trade.
- **Terms:** UK of Great Britain and Ireland; **100 MPs**; 28 peers and 4 bishops; united churches; free trade.
- **Controversies:** bought with peerages, places and £1.25 million compensation (Castlereagh, Cornwallis); Protestant patriots opposed; Catholics accepted it expecting **Emancipation** — refused by George III; Pitt resigned; granted only **1829**.
- **Impact:** nationalism becomes **Catholic** and national — Emmet, O'Connell, Young Ireland, Fenians, Home Rule, **1922**; the **Irish Question** destabilised British politics (1846, 1886, 1910).

R3.7 Britain and the Napoleonic Wars

- **Why Britain fought:** the Low Countries, the balance of power, trade, ideology.
- **Strategy:** sea power, subsidies (seven coalitions), the Peninsula, the Orders in Council.

- **Why Britain won: Trafalgar**; money (income tax, credit); industry; allies; **Wellington**; Napoleon's errors in Spain and Russia.
- **Vienna**: balance of power; Concert of Europe; Malta, Cape, Ceylon, Mauritius, Heligoland.
- **Impact**: cost £1,000 million; debt £745 million; the Corn Law (1815); Luddism; Peterloo and the Six Acts (1819); a century of naval supremacy.

R3.8 Dates to write in every answer

1783 Pitt · **14 Jul 1789** Bastille · **1790** Burke · **1791–92** Paine · **1792** LCS · **1 Feb 1793** war · **1794** habeas corpus suspended · **1795** Two Acts · **1798** Irish rising; the Nile · **1799** income tax; Combination Acts · **1 Jan 1801** Union · **21 Oct 1805** Trafalgar · **1808–14** Peninsula · **18 Jun 1815** Waterloo.

VERDICT · The whole topic in one sentence

The French Revolution divided Britain, frightened its rulers into repression and the Union with Ireland, and gave it the ideas of both conservatism and radicalism; the wars that followed cost a thousand million pounds and left Britain the world's only global power.